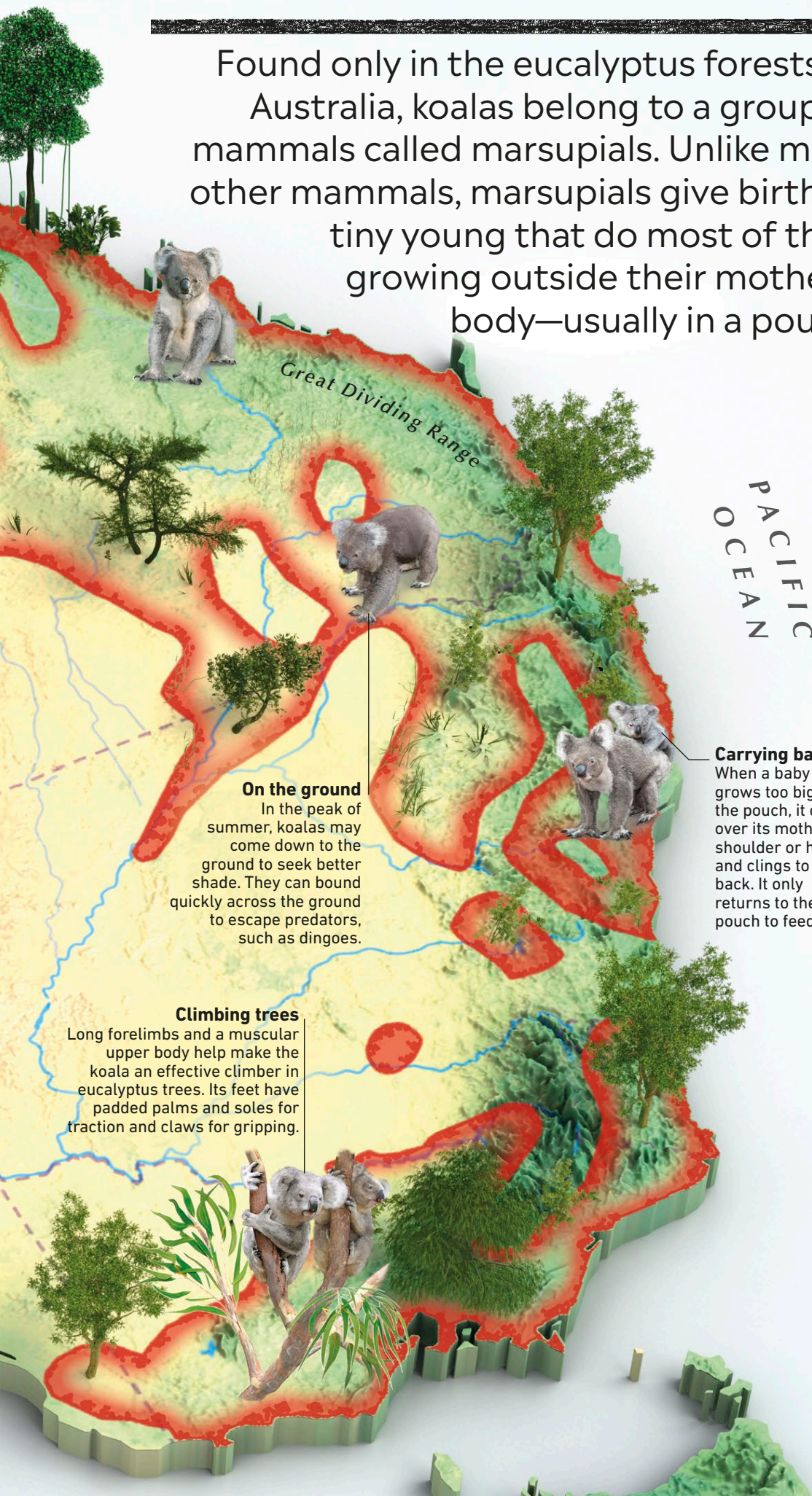


# Koala

Found only in the eucalyptus forests of Australia, koalas belong to a group of mammals called marsupials. Unlike most other mammals, marsupials give birth to tiny young that do most of their growing outside their mother's body—usually in a pouch.



## On the ground

In the peak of summer, koalas may come down to the ground to seek better shade. They can bound quickly across the ground to escape predators, such as dingoes.

## Climbing trees

Long forelimbs and a muscular upper body help make the koala an effective climber in eucalyptus trees. Its feet have padded palms and soles for traction and claws for gripping.

PACIFIC  
OCEAN

## Carrying babies

When a baby koala grows too big for the pouch, it climbs over its mother's shoulder or head and clings to her back. It only returns to the pouch to feed.

## OTHER MARSUPIALS



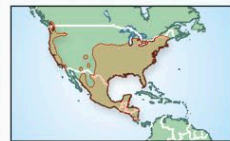
### Red kangaroo

The largest species of kangaroo is well adapted to cope with Australia's dry interior, and ranges widely over the semi-deserts of the country.



### Goodfellow's tree kangaroo

In the tropical rainforests of New Guinea, Goodfellow's tree kangaroos have evolved to climb through the branches.



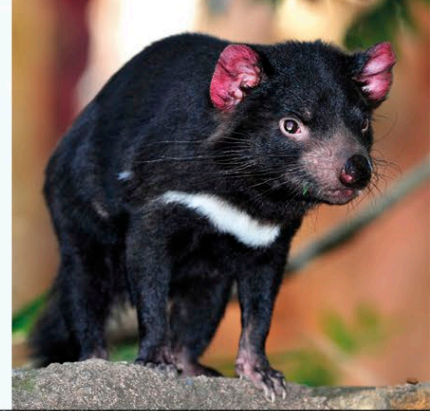
### Virginia opossum

There are 120 species of opossums, mostly found in tropical South and Central America. Only the Virginia opossum ranges into temperate North America.



### Tasmanian devil

The carnivorous Tasmanian devil used to be widespread across all of Australia, but is now restricted to the southern island of Tasmania.



### Bear cuscus

Living in tropical lowland forests on the Indonesian island of Sulawesi, the bear cuscus is the most western-dwelling marsupial in Australasia and Oceania.

